



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Christ the King Academy

School Website: <https://christthekingacademy.org/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Christ the King Academy (CKA) in Centralia/Chehalis, WA presents a robust classical Christian program that emphasizes discipleship, classical formation, and strong parental partnership. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as discipleship within a Christian worldview, highlight classical elements (Latin, logic, rhetoric; Great Books; memorization; chant/singing), and stress active parental involvement. The school has explicit statements about being "robustly Christian" and "thoroughly classical," a strong staff culture, and a schedule and pedagogy that foreground formation, virtue, and spiritual aims alongside intellectual aims. Across six classical criteria, CK A demonstrates strong classical alignment in most domains, with Pedagogy showing strongest alignment to traditional classical practice and some room for broader implementation of Socratic/seminar-based methods. Overall, the school is classified as CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site frames education as discipleship and explicitly grounds all subjects in a Christian worldview: "We believe that education is discipleship; it is never neutral. We unashamedly teach every subject from a distinctively Christian worldview." - It proclaims being "Thoroughly Classical" and emphasizes a Christian frame across disciplines (e.g., Classical education has the goal of a life of wisdom and virtue in Christ). - The site highlights liturgical and communal elements (singing Psalms/Hymns daily; Bible/poetry memorization; emphasis on theology and sacred tradition) and a parent-emphasized, worshipful community culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, virtue, wisdom, moral formation, theology, sacred tradition, liturgy, Psalms/Hymns, worship, discipleship, divine order, Logos, Christian worldview, orderly and sacred learning. These align with Positive Keywords for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (e.g., virtue, wisdom, transcendence, liturgical practices, theology, sacred tradition). - Negative keywords: Not evident in public materials; no explicit statements of secularism, value-neutrality, or relativism. The absence of these negatives reinforces alignment with classical religious foundations.

Why this rating - The school consistently foregrounds a Christian worldview, virtue-centered aims, liturgical practices (psalms/hymns), and a theology-grounded curriculum, which fulfills the core positive indicators for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations in classical education rubrics. The absence of secular or relativistic signals supports a CLASSICAL rating here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The mission and vision articulate formation of character and mind through a classical, Christian lens: "robustly Christian and thoroughly Classical" with a goal of shaping thinking for discernment and understanding; partnership with parents to raise children in the nurture of the Lord. - Public text notes that education should form virtue and wisdom rather than be solely job-training; formation over information is clearly present (e.g., "education is formation rather than information"). - The stated aim includes training

students to think clearly, discern, and articulate themselves within a Christian framework; a telos toward virtue and wisdom is explicit.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, telos, pursuit of true/good/beautiful, human flourishing, moral imagination, love of learning, sacred tradition, Logos, contemplation, restoration of cultural inheritance. These map onto Positive Keyword indicators for School Purpose and Goal. - Negative keywords: No explicit emphasis on workforce/career-readiness or 21st-century skills in the public-facing messaging; the focus remains formation and virtue rooted in Christian tradition. This supports CLASSICAL rather than a critical “workforce-first” stance.

Why this rating - CK A consistently frames education as a formation of character and intellect toward virtue, wisdom, and truth within a Christian telos, aligning with the CLASSICAL category for Purpose and Goal.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Explicit mention of liberal arts foundations: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin/Greek as classical elements; reference to Great Books and the Great Conversation; integration of history and literature with a unified approach; emphasis on wonder. Public materials specifically name Latin, Logic, and Rhetoric and the study of classical subjects. - Curriculum descriptions cite Great Books and primary sources, and the Great Conversation framing appears in governance/discipline discussions and external materials referencing classical texts and traditions. - The school communicates a Four + One model and a rhythm that emphasizes in-class classical work plus home-based study, consistent with classical curricular structure and restfulness in learning (Scholé-like rhythm implied by the weekly schedule).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books, primary sources, classical texts, Latin, historical breadth, integration of subjects, wonder, sacred tradition, classical pedagogy, imitatio (modeled excellence), and memory work. - Negative keywords: No substantial signals of replacing history with social studies; no heavy emphasis on project-based, STEM-first, or secular modern curricula in public materials. The presence of Great Books and classical structure argues against the negatives.

Why this rating - CK A's curriculum language strongly aligns with liberal arts education, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin/logic/rhetoric, and a historically grounded, wonder-infused approach. This supports a CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy features singing, chanting, memory work, and recitation (e.g., Psalms, hymns, Bible/Poetry memorization; regular memory-based practices). - Upper-school pedagogy mentions Socratic discussion and rhetoric training in classical models as part of classical education, and “great conversation” framing appears in standards and external texts. Public materials reference Socratic dialogue and debates in classical pedagogy, though explicit, school-wide deployment across grades is less clearly documented in the site's text. - The school uses a Four + One model and a schedule that includes in-class instruction plus home-based work, combining contemplative/restful elements with more rigorous, subject-focused work.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation, chanting, imitation of models, Socratic dialogue (as a concept referenced in pedagogy materials), and rhetoric training. The site shows strong memory-based practices (recitation/chanting) and a classical emphasis on restfulness at times (evidenced by “Four + One” pacing and mention of contemplative learning in public texts). - Negative keywords: Some elements of modern, project-based/experiential learning are not prominent in the public-facing materials; however, the site does show modern scheduling and home-learning components aligned with the Four + One model. The materials do not foreground heavy project-based, constructivist, or strictly experiential-only pedagogy. This yields a mixed signal leaning toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - CK A demonstrates core classical pedagogy features (memory work, recitation, model-formation, and a classical curriculum) but the explicit deployment of Socratic seminars and other high-school-specific seminar formats is not as plainly documented as the other elements. The presence of both strong classical practices and mixed pedagogical formats supports a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy, with a clear needle-mover potential if Socratic/seminar scaffolding is expanded.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as “model teachers and mentors who model virtue, skill, and knowledge” and as the “living curriculum,” with a spiritually and intellectually coherent culture. The staff page emphasizes teachers as partners with parents to shape students and reflect shared values. - The school highlights the faculty as a core of the school, with a portrait of what a teacher should be and what a student should be implied through the public materials (staff bios, classroom emphasis, and the “living curriculum” framing).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, virtue, character formation, mastery, collegial culture, teachers as guides, faith and reason, professional excellence. These map directly onto Positive Keywords for Faculty in classical rubrics. - Negative keywords: No public signals of teacher-centric, non-classical pedagogical models that would signal a deviation from classical norms. The textual materials emphasize teacher virtue and mentorship.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials consistently portray faculty as virtuous, mentorship-oriented, and central to the school’s formation mission, aligning with CLASSICAL criteria for Faculty.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school repeatedly emphasizes partnering with parents, calling parents co-teachers and primary influencers, and offering parent formation opportunities (e.g., theology/bible gatherings, book studies, Parent Academy). It frames the school as a school-home partnership and invites parent involvement. - Public materials show explicit parental formation content (Theology & Bible, Parent Academy), and openness to visits and parent participation (FAQ, Visit pages). The charter mentions parent engagement as a core feature of classical education. - The school highlights community involvement and the ability for families to participate, aligning with the classical model of partnership with families and a shared mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parental involvement, co-teachers, parent formation, home-school partnership, family catechesis, school-parent synergy, open campus/visits. These are strong Positive Keywords for Parents and Community in classical rubrics. - Negative keywords: No signals of consumer-focused parent relations or limited parental access; the site consistently invites parental engagement. This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - CK A demonstrates robust parental partnership, community formation, and parental formation activities, aligning with the CLASSICAL rubric for Parents & Community.

Overall assessment (aggregate)

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Aggregate ranking: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Pedagogy (Element 4):
 - Intensify explicit Socratic dialogue and seminar-based pedagogy across upper and lower grades, with documented schedules and teacher training to implement Harkness-style discussions. This

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- would convert SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL into CLASSICAL by strengthening the primary method of uncovering truth through dialectic.
- Expand Great Books exposure across disciplines and ensure explicit articulation of “Great Conversation” in core courses (history, literature, philosophy, math) to deepen integration of the curriculum with classical texts.
 - Increase explicit use of scholé/restful learning in daily routines, with dedicated periods for contemplative reading and reflection embedded in the weekly schedule, reinforcing the restful-learning dimension.
- Curriculum (Element 3): Maintain and amplify Great Books/read-original-text emphasis, ensuring explicit primary-source engagement in more courses and integrating classical texts across more disciplines to fortify the Great Conversation.
 - Faculty (Element 5) and Parents & Community (Element 6):
 - Continue expanding the “living curriculum” by providing teacher collaboratives that model virtue and professional formation, with formal portraits and standards that articulate teacher virtues and student virtues in public materials.
 - Broaden parent formation through regular book clubs, lectures, and theology-based study groups that are widely publicized and accessible to new families; deepen parent-co-teacher collaborations to solidify the partnership ethos.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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